

**Low-latency doodling**

Google Chrome Canvas PWA brings low-latency doodling to Chromebooks, Android and even desktop. <https://dgit.in/jan19-27>

**WhatsApp cryptocurrency?**

Facebook is allegedly developing cryptocurrency that enables money transfer on WhatsApp between users. <https://dgit.in/jan19-28>

Apple MacBook Air 2018

Lighter, faster, costlier



Price
₹1,14,900

B

y the time 2017 started coming to a close, people started to

wonder when Apple would refresh the MacBook Air line. Apple finally announced the much-wanted refresh earlier this year and we've tried to figure out if the new laptop lives up to the legacy of its predecessor.



FEATURES.....	68
PERFORMANCE.....	72
BUILD	79
VALUE FOR MONEY....	61

there is a generous slab of capacitive glass lying on top of Apple's Taptic Engine. On either side lie

force sensors which translate to the feedback you receive. The gesture-based navigation is intuitive and registration does not fail even a single time.

Display

The new MacBook Air brings you a Retina IPS display with the resolution of 2560x1600 and a higher than sRGB colour gamut coverage. The MacBook Air has colour reproduction accurate enough to be used as a professional photo-editing display. The display also gets really bright. What Samsung's OLED is to smartphones, Apple's IPS LCD is to the laptop world and the MacBook Air comes equipped with one amazing panel.

Performance

Interestingly, when we measured the read/write disk-speed on the MacBook Air in comparison to our 2016 MacBook Pro, the Air's storage came out noticeably slower. Let's now move to how the MacBook Air performs in real life. The MacBook Air managed to last a solid 8 hours of use with the brightness set to half and Wi-Fi turned on. Running a Lightroom Catalog

with close to 13,000 photos was no problem, but editing individual high-resolution RAW files did see the machine stutter a little bit. For example, when switching from the library to the develop module, the image not only took a good 6 seconds to load, but the preview itself loaded in parts. Additionally, moving the adjustment sliders around wasn't a smooth experience.

Battery Life

The Apple MacBook Air comes with a 50.3Whr Lithium Polymer battery that Apple says should last you about 12-13 hours, depending on the use case. While we continually clocked a solid 8 hours, we also know that had we eliminated photo editing from our day, the machine would have easily clocked 10 hours of use. The topping up of this battery takes closer to two and a half hours with the provided charger, which is a 30Watt Power Delivery charger that charges the machine over USB-C. what this means is that while you're charging the MacBook Air, you lose one of the two ports, which is a bummer for sure.

Bottomline

The Apple MacBook Air 2018 refresh improves on what was already considered the best ultrabook, but at the same time, also brings in a significant price bump. If you're not an Apple loyalist, you're not going to be very impressed with the MacBook Air's offerings, in comparison to what the Windows counterparts have to offer. It is no longer the best value for money device. It is still a great device for work which is guaranteed to last you a few years. It is perfect for watching movies as well, but if you're looking for a photo or video editing machine, this is definitely not it.

—Swapnil Mathur

Build and Design

The chassis is now slightly slimmer, the body size is smaller, all thanks to the display coming with a slimmer bezel. Skipping the Touchbar, Apple has accommodated a bigger touchpad. Two Thunderbolt 3 ports can be found on the left side of the machine, with the headphone jack on the right.

The MacBook Air is a whole 100 grams lighter. Apple has also incorporated TouchID into the MacBook Air as a square button that's also the power button.

Keyboard and Trackpad

On the new MacBook Air, typing is a far more enjoyable experience, especially given how eerily quiet the keys can be. For those with gentle fingers, this is for sure a pleasant keyboard to type on. Moving onto the trackpad,

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: 8th gen Intel Core i5 | STORAGE: 128GB/256GB PCIe-based SSD | MEMORY: 8GB (2133MHz, LPDDR3) | WEIGHT: 1.25 kg | GRAPHICS: Intel UHD Graphics 617

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